Lan E. Luo

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Academic Appointment

Yale School of Management, Yale University
Assistant Professor of Marketing — Jul 2026–Present

Education

Columbia University
Ph.D. Marketing — 2026
Committee: Olivier Toubia, Oded Netzer, Asim Ansari, Andrey Simonov, Ryan Dew
M.Phil. Marketing — 2024

Yale University
B.A. Economics; B.A. Statistics & Data Science (Honors) — 2020

Research Interests

Substantive: Data-Driven Design, User-Generated Content, Digital Advertising, Social Issues
Methodological: Interpretable Machine Learning, Applied Econometrics, Probabilistic Machine Learning, Causal Inference, Deep Generative Modeling

Journal Publications

Frontiers: Discrimination Against Femininity in Headshots: A Field Experiment with AI-Enabled Controllable Stimuli Generation
Lan E. Luo and Olivier Toubia
Marketing Science, 2026

Probabilistic Machine Learning: New Frontiers for Modeling Consumers and their Choices
Ryan Dew, Nicolas Padilla, **Lan E. Luo**, Shin Oblander, Asim Ansari, Khaled Boughanmi, Michael Braun, Fred Feinberg, Jia Liu, Thomas Otter, Longxiu Tian, Yixin Wang, and Mingzhang Yin
International Journal of Research in Marketing, 2026

Public attitudes value interpretability but prioritize accuracy in Artificial Intelligence
Anne-Marie Nussberger, **Lan Luo**, L. Elisa Celis, and Molly J. Crockett
Nature Communications, 2022

Working Papers

How Visual Designs Drive Success: Sparse Autoencoders for Interpretable Discovery and Data-Driven Generative Design
Lan E. Luo
Draft available upon request

Works in Progress *(* indicates equal authorship)*

Theory-Guided AI Conversations as Flexible Choice Architecture: Evidence from Retirement Benefit Claiming
Daniel Russman*, **Lan E. Luo***, Alisa Wu*, and Eric J. Johnson

Sparse Autoencoders Reveal (and Generate) the Drivers of Online Sharing
Reed Orchinik*, **Lan E. Luo***

How Livestreaming Chats Engage Consumers
Lan E. Luo*, Eric S. Park*

Causality in Conversations
Ryan Dew*, Yu Ding*, **Lan E. Luo***

AI-Powered Conjoint Analysis
Ryan Dew, **Lan E. Luo**

Invited Seminar Talks *(includes scheduled talks)*

Shidler College of Business, University of Hawaii at Manoa	May 2027
Booth School of Business, University of Chicago	Feb2027
SC Johnson Graduate School of Management, Cornell University	Nov2026
The Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania	Oct2025
C. T. Bauer College of Business, University of Houston	Oct2025
Yale School of Management	Oct2025
Tuck School of Business, Dartmouth College	Oct2025
Lee Kong Chian School of Business, Singapore Management University	Sep2025
NUS Business School, National University of Singapore	Sep2025
INSEAD	Sep2025
Sauder School of Business, University of British Columbia	Sep2025
McCombs School of Business, University of Texas at Austin	Aug2025

Conference & Workshop Presentations *(includes scheduled presentations)*

Amazon Science Seminar, Online — Nov2026
- *How Visual Designs Drive Success: Sparse Autoencoders for Interpretable Discovery and Data-Driven Generative Design*

Virtual Quantitative Marketing Seminar, Online — Oct2026
- *How Visual Designs Drive Success: Sparse Autoencoders for Interpretable Discovery and Data-Driven Generative Design*

Thirteenth Triennial Choice Symposium, University of Colorado Boulder, Vail, Colorado — Aug2026
- *Seeing Choice: Visual Cues and Decision-Making*

ISMS Marketing Science Conference, Nova School of Business and Economics, Carcavelos, Portugal — Jun2026
- *How Visual Designs Drive Success: Sparse Autoencoders for Interpretable Discovery and Data-Driven Generative Design*

GenAI Lab, Technical University of Munich, Online Jan2026
- *How Visual Designs Drive Success: Sparse Autoencoders for Interpretable Discovery and Data-Driven Generative Design*

Conference on Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, and Business Analytics, Columbia University, New York Dec2025
- *How Visual Designs Drive Success: Sparse Autoencoders for Interpretable Discovery and Data-Driven Generative Design*

GenAI in Marketing & Advertising Roundtable, Meta, New York Nov2025
- *How Visual Designs Drive Success: Sparse Autoencoders for Interpretable Discovery and Data-Driven Generative Design*

ISMS Marketing Science Conference, University of Georgia, Washington, D.C. Jun2025
- *How Visual Designs Drive Success: Sparse Autoencoders for Interpretable Discovery and Data-Driven Generative Design*

ISMS Marketing Science Conference, UNSW Sydney, Australia Jun2024
- *Discrimination Against Femininity in Headshots: A Field Experiment with AI-Enabled Controllable Stimuli Generation*

Symposium on Artificial Intelligence in Marketing, University of Wisconsin–Madison May 2024
- *Discrimination Against Femininity in Headshots: A Field Experiment with AI-Enabled Controllable Stimuli Generation*

Twelfth Triennial Choice Symposium, INSEAD, Fontainebleau, France Aug2023
- *Probabilistic Machine Learning for Scalable, Flexible, and Interpretable Models of Choice*

ISMS Marketing Science Conference, University of Miami, Florida Jun2023
- *Discrimination Against Femininity in Headshots: A Field Experiment with AI-Enabled Controllable Stimuli Generation*

Awards & Honors

Finalist, American Statistical Association's Marketing Dissertation Award	2026
AMA-Sheth Foundation Doctoral Consortium Fellow	2025
Columbia Experimental Laboratory in the Social Sciences Travel Grant	2024
W. Edwards Deming Center Doctoral Fellowship	2023
Bernstein Center for Leadership and Ethics Doctoral Research Grant	2022
Don Lehmann Scholar Award	2020
Yale Hartigan Undergraduate Senior Thesis Prize for Statistics & Data Science	2020
Richter Summer Fellowship Research Award	2019
Herb Scarf Fellowship Research Award in Economics	2018
Tobin Research Award in Economics	2018

Teaching Experience

Instructor *Yale School of Management*

Generative AI and Social Media (MGT 575, MBA) Spring 2027

Academic Service *(includes scheduled service)*

Conference Discussant

– Discussant, "Platforms and Digital Economy," Allied Social Science Associations (ASSA) Annual Meeting, American Economic Association, January 2027

Conference Session Organization

– Session Co-Organizer, "Generative AI for Marketing Measurement, Experimentation, and Design," ISMS Marketing Science Conference, June 2026

Industry Experience

Analysis Group, *Summer Analyst Intern* 2019

Skills

Languages: English (native); Mandarin, French (proficient); Korean, Japanese (basic)
Programming: Python, R (fluent); Stata, Stan, Mathematica, Java, SQL (familiar)